

MIRROR PAGE

A dark comic adventure: find your friend among the vampires, and free the captured hero. • TGC Game Jam 2026 Proposal

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IndieConnect ID	@sankeerthnara (indieconnect.in/@sankeerthnara)	Public GitHub	github.com/SankeerthNara/TGC-Game-Jam (MIT)
Themes (All 3)	COMIC TWIST LIGHT	Target Playtime	17 – 19 mins first playthrough (20 min hard cap)
Engine & Renderer	Godot 4.7, GDScript only, GL Compatibility Renderer (Web/HTML5 export hosted on itch.io)		

1. PITCH & CORE CONCEPT

The game opens with a cutscene: the Earth once lived in peace, guarded by **four superheroes**, until a **masked villain** covered it in darkness. A fixed **Narrator** then tells four comic stories in a row. Each is built for one comic hero (superhero, noir detective, manga ninja, pop-art space hero) in a **pitch-dark level of 8 rooms in a random layout** where only your torch is lit; you finish interactive tasks to fill a progress bar. **Level 1 is a calm warm-up**, and at its end the Narrator captures that hero. **From level 2**, two identical **vampires** lurk in the dark: your **friend** and the comic's **villain** (random), who starts **timed sabotage**. Catch one in your torchlight (Among Us style cutscene) and choose **REVEAL** or **KILL**: reveal a friend and he becomes an ally who no longer fears light; reveal the villain and you are teleported into a 30 to 60 second parkour chase; kill the villain and he is gone; kill a friend and he dies. After four levels the heroes of levels 2, 3 and 4 fight the **Narrator one on one**, each with his own special power, to free the captured hero. The first two are canonically defeated, but each cracks a layer of the Narrator's power; the level 4 hero finishes it: if he wins, sunlight makes the Narrator evaporate; if not, he throws the captured hero into lava. A closing cutscene mirrors the opening: the Earth in sunlight with its heroes, or still in darkness.

2. INTEGRATION OF THE THREE THEMES

Theme	How It Drives Gameplay & Narrative
Comic	A fixed Narrator frames four comic worlds, each with its own hero and look (ink outlines, halftone paper, caption boxes, onomatopoeia). The light puzzles are comic pages whose panels you drag around.
Light	Every level is dark: only the area around your torch is visible, so light is how you explore, how you catch vampires (they freeze when held in the beam) and how you solve the mirror puzzles and the final duels.
Twist	Friend or villain? Two identical vampires, chosen at random, so every Reveal or Kill is a gamble with four different outcomes. The Narrator is the final twist: he captured the first hero and is the real saboteur. He also tampers with the interface and the puzzle rules.

3. CORE MECHANICS

- **Explore the dark:** smooth 8-direction walking in a random 8-room layout that is new every level. Press M for the map.
- **28 interactive tasks over 4 levels, none repeated:** comic tasks (order panels, speech bubbles, sound effects, connect the dots, ink mixing), college tasks (debug code, logic gates, quiz, proofreading, safe cracking) and classics (wires, fuses, pipes, memory), plus 6 light-puzzle pages with rule twists (lying mirrors, light that bends at gutters, goal flip).
- **Villain-started sabotage:** from level 2 the villain vampire walks to a spot and starts a timer; a fix console must be completed in time or you lose hearts (big sabotage: 2 hearts). In level 4 he also undoes one finished task.
- **Vampires, Reveal or Kill:** hold the torch on a vampire for an Among Us style cutscene, then choose. Reveal the friend: an ally who ignores light and helps more each level. Reveal the villain: you are teleported into a 30 to 60 second parkour chase against the clock. Kill the villain: he is gone. Kill the friend: he dies and your ending suffers.
- **Adaptive difficulty and score:** going over par makes the next level a little easier; a score (tasks, sabotage stopped, hearts, deaths, choices, small time bonus) gives S/A/B/C ranks. Checkpoints at each level start; level and total timers.

4. LEVELS AND HEROES

#	Hero and world	Par	Tasks	Vampires, sabotage and friend help
1	Superhero pulp	2:00	4	Warm-up: no vampires, no sabotage. At the end the Narrator captures this hero.
2	Noir detective	3:00	6	Vampires appear. 1 sabotage. Revealed friend points to the nearest task.
3	Manga ninja	4:00	8	2 big sabotages. Friend also finishes small tasks and adds time.
4	Pop-art space hero	5:00	10	2 big sabotages and a task undone. Friend also fixes a sabotage and shields you once.

5. FINAL BOSS, CUTSCENES AND ENDINGS

- **Relay duels, special powers:** after level 4 the heroes of levels 2, 3 and 4 fight the Narrator one on one, in that order, at least 3 minutes in all. Each hero has his own special power: the noir detective's *Deduction* (slows time and shows the Narrator's next attack), the manga ninja's *Light Dash* (a fast dash that slices through ink), the space hero's *Prism Cannon* (splits and reflects a beam, and charges a Solar Flare). It is canon that the level 2 and level 3 heroes are defeated, but each one cracks a layer of the Narrator's dark shield. The level 4 hero faces the weakened Narrator, and what you did earlier (friends revealed or killed, how well the first duels went) decides how hard that last duel is.
- **Two endings:** if the level 4 hero wins, his Solar Flare floods the room with sunlight and the Narrator evaporates. If he loses, the Narrator throws the captured level 1 hero into lava.
- **Cutscenes:** an opening cutscene (the peaceful Earth guarded by four superheroes, then covered in darkness by a masked villain) and a mirrored closing cutscene (sunlight returns, or darkness stays, depending on the ending). In between, Among Us style scenes for detecting a vampire, revealing a friend, revealing the villain (ending in a teleport to the parkour), killing a friend or the villain (ejection into space), and the level 1 capture. All are skippable.

6. SCOPE BOUNDARIES

In Scope: 4 generated dark levels with torch lighting, 28 tasks (never repeated), villain sabotage, hearts and checkpoints, two vampires with the Reveal / Kill choice and friend ally, parkour chase, relay boss duels, cutscenes, score and ranks, narrator and four heroes, menus, sound and music, web export.

Out of Scope (Strictly Cut): level editor, save slots, mobile touch, gamepads, multiplayer, more than 4 levels or heroes, any existing comic character (all heroes and villains are original).

7. TECHNICAL ARCHITECTURE & WEB FEASIBILITY

- **Godot 4.7, GDScript only, GL Compatibility renderer:** single-threaded Web export, no native extensions. 2D lights and darkness verified in a browser build.
- **Data-driven and testable:** a pure-logic puzzle model with headless unit tests and a brute-force solver that proves every puzzle solvable; levels are generated at run time (8 rooms, corridors, consoles) and a generator test checks that 100+ levels are fully reachable. Every task is its own class registered by name.
- **Status at proposal time:** the whole loop already runs: levels, tasks, sabotage, vampires, choice, parkour, cutscenes, score and checkpoints.

8. 100-HOUR DEVELOPMENT MILESTONES

Hours	Phase & Deliverables	Current Status
0 – 12	Concept lock, core engine and levels, tasks, sabotage, vampires, parkour, cutscenes, proposal.	COMPLETE
12 – 30	Narrator system, hero and theme for level 1, tutorial, level 1 capture cutscene, polish of the vampire choice.	NEXT
30 – 55	Heroes and themes for levels 2 and 3, friend ally and parkour polish, first outside playtests.	Planned
55 – 75	Level 4, the three relay duels, sunlight and lava endings, transitions, fourth-wall twists, shader, audio.	Planned
75 – 85	Balance, par times, playtests, bug fixing. Feature freeze at Hour 85.	Planned
85 – 100	Fixes only, web export, itch.io page, README and CREDITS audit, submission by Hour 96.	Planned

9. ASSETS & AI DISCLOSURE

- **Assets:** no paid assets. Fonts **Bangers** and **Comic Neue** (SIL OFL 1.1); sound effects and music generated procedurally (CC0); all art is drawn in code or generated procedurally. Every asset is listed in CREDITS.md. The open-source Godot AI plugin (MIT) is used in the editor only and is not part of the game.
- **AI tools:** Claude Code (architecture and gameplay code), Antigravity (UI, art and audio, browser tests) and ChatGPT/Codex (tests and documents), all logged in docs/AI_USAGE.md. Story, design decisions, characters and direction are the developer's own.

10. RISKS & MITIGATIONS

Identified Risk	Proactive Mitigation Strategy
Scope (four heroes, duels, cutscenes)	Everything shares one engine, one cutscene template and one duel engine; a written cut list and a feature freeze at Hour 85.
A pure-chance choice feels unfair	All four outcomes are fun, not punishing; early playtests at Hour 30; level 1 is a safe warm-up.
Combat or parkour is not fun	Simple readable mechanics, playtests at Hours 45 and 70, fallbacks (shorter parkour, duels without mirrors).
Web export or performance bugs	Browser test on every milestone, Compatibility renderer from day one, small asset budget.

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Implementation plan for Hours 12 to 100. Four comic heroes, one narrator, two vampires: friend or villain? Reveal or kill.

Developer	Sankeerth Nara (solo)	Repository	github.com/SankeerthNara/TGC-Game-Jam (public, MIT)
Themes	Comic, Twist, Light (all three)	Engine	Godot 4.7, GDScript, Compatibility renderer, Web export
Final playtime	About 17 to 19 minutes (20 max)	Plan status	Concept locked at Hour 12. Features below are committed or marked stretch.

1. THE GAME IN ONE PARAGRAPH

The game opens with a cutscene: the peaceful Earth, guarded by four superheroes, is covered in darkness by a masked villain. A fixed **Narrator** frames four comic stories; each level is built for one original comic hero (superhero pulp, noir detective, manga ninja, pop-art space hero) whom you play, in a pitch-dark floor of 8 rooms in a random layout where only your torch is lit. You finish interactive tasks (never repeated in a run) against a par time of about 2, 3, 4 and 5 minutes. **Level 1 is a calm warm-up** with no sabotage and no vampires; at its end the Narrator captures the level 1 hero. **From level 2** two identical **vampires** hide in the dark, a **friend** and the comic's **villain** (random). The villain starts each sabotage himself. Hold your torch on a vampire for an Among Us style cutscene, then choose **REVEAL** or **KILL**; every outcome has its own cutscene. Revealing the villain teleports you into a **30 to 60 second parkour chase** against the clock (lose and you lose a heart). Going over par makes the next level a little easier; a score that is not just time ranks each level. After level 4, **the heroes of levels 2, 3 and 4 fight the Narrator one on one with their own special powers; the first two are canonically defeated, the level 4 hero decides the ending.**

Level	Par	Tasks	Vampires and sabotage	Friend help (when revealed)
1	2:00	4	None. Warm-up; the Narrator captures the hero at the end.	-
2	3:00	6	Vampires appear. 1 sabotage, started by the villain.	Points an arrow to the nearest unfinished task.
3	4:00	8	2 big sabotages (2 hearts, harder fix, shorter timer).	Also finishes small tasks and adds time to sabotage timers.
4	5:00	10	2 big sabotages, plus the villain undoes one finished task.	Also fixes a sabotage himself and shields you once.
If the vampire is...		REVEAL (cutscene, then...)		KILL (ejection cutscene, then...)
The friend		He becomes your ally and is no longer scared of light.		He dies, you lose a heart, and the final fight gets harder.
The villain		He bolts: parkour chase. Catch him: sabotage stops, +1 heart.		He dies at once and the sabotage stops, but no heart bonus.

Already built at Hour 12: the dark levels with torch lighting and 8-direction movement, a generator for random 8-room levels, 26 distinct task types plus 6 light-puzzle pages, progress bar, sabotage countdowns with fix consoles, hearts, checkpoints and respawn, level and total timers, par times, adaptive difficulty, score and ranks, map screen, the vampires (patrol, flee from light, freeze in the beam), the villain who starts sabotage, the Reveal / Kill choice, the friend ally, the parkour chase, and the Among Us style cutscenes for detecting a vampire and for every reveal and kill. Level 1 is already a warm-up with no vampires.

2. COMMITTED FEATURES FOR THE REMAINING 88 HOURS

#	Feature	What it adds	Hours
1	Narrator and four comic heroes	One narrator character (portrait, speech bubbles, text blips) commenting through all four levels, and four original heroes (no existing characters) with their own look, ability and a themed level (palette, fonts, props, room names, task skins, music). Level 1 ends with the Narrator capturing hero 1 (Comic).	14
2	Vampires and the choice (polish)	Tuning and fairness of the pure-chance choice, clues in the world (ink drips, red eyes), balancing of the four outcomes and their rewards (Light + Twist).	8
3	The friend ally (polish)	Help that grows each level, ally animations, how a friend you killed changes the ending and the final fight.	5
4	Parkour chase (polish)	Better level pieces per hero theme, enemies from level 3, fair difficulty, 30 to 60 second target.	6
5	Final boss: relay duels vs the Narrator	Three one-on-one rounds in order: the level 2 hero, level 3, then level 4, at least 3 minutes in all. Each hero has his own special power (noir detective: <i>Deduction</i> , slows time and shows the next attack; manga ninja: <i>Light Dash</i> , a fast dash that slices ink; space hero: <i>Prism Cannon</i> , splits and reflects a beam and charges a <i>Solar Flare</i>). It is canon that the level 2 and 3 heroes are defeated: each round is a timed survive-and-hit round (about a minute) that ends with the hero knocked out, but cracks one layer of the Narrator's shield. The level 4 hero fights the weakened Narrator; earlier friends and how well rounds 1 and 2 went make round 3 easier or harder. Win: the Solar Flare floods the room with sunlight and the Narrator evaporates. Lose: he throws the level 1 hero into lava (Twist).	14
6	More cutscenes	The opening cutscene (peaceful Earth guarded by four superheroes, covered in darkness by a masked villain) and a mirrored closing cutscene (sunlight and the four heroes again, or darkness that stays). Plus polish of the vampire cutscenes, the level 1 capture, the hero swaps between duels, the sunlight ending and the lava ending. One reusable template, skippable, under 5 seconds each (except the opening and endings).	9
7	Fourth-wall twists	The Narrator tampers with captions, the progress bar, the map and the controls for short moments.	2
8	Comic look and juice	Ink and halftone screen shader, panel-split level transitions, onomatopoeia on actions and hits.	3
9	Score and ranks (done) + saved bests	Per-level and run score (time is only a small bonus), S/A/B/C ranks, best scores saved locally.	2
10	First-minute polish	30 second tutorial in level 1, controls hints, itch.io page with GIFs, README, CREDITS, AI usage log.	5

11	Balance and testing	Tuning of task counts and difficulty to hit the par times, sabotage timers, the parkour and the duels; outside playtests; bug fixing; web performance.	10
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STRETCH (only after all of the above are playable, in this order): friends from earlier levels fighting beside the heroes, a torch battery with recharge lamps, reactive music. **Cut first** if time is short: stretch items, then hero abilities, then per-hero task skins (fallback: palette swaps only), then the mirror part of the duels (fallback: a torch-only duel).

Fixed limits: 4 levels and 4 heroes (no more), original characters only (no existing comic heroes or villains), no multiplayer, no save slots, no level editor, no new engine features.

3. ROADMAP AND MILESTONES

Hours	Work	Exit criteria (a playable build every 12 hours)
12 - 30	Plan locked. Clean-up of unused code. Narrator system (portrait, bubbles, event lines). Hero and theme for level 1. Vampire movement (patrol, flee from light, freeze in the beam). Tutorial skeleton.	Level 1 plays start to finish in the browser with the Narrator and a vampire to catch.
30 - 55	Polish of the vampire choice, friend ally and parkour. Heroes and themes for levels 2 and 3. Level 1 capture cutscene. First playtest of the choice at Hour 30.	Levels 1 to 3 playable with both vampires, the choice and the villain fight.
55 - 75	Level 4 hero and theme, the three relay duels vs the Narrator, the sunlight and lava ending cutscenes, level transitions, fourth-wall twists, shader, audio mix.	Full 17 to 19 minute run from menu through the 3 minute boss to an ending.
75 - 85	Balance pass, outside playtests, bug fixing, performance, accessibility. Feature freeze at Hour 85.	No known blocking bugs; the choice, par times and fights confirmed fair by testers.
85 - 96	Only fixes. Final web export, itch.io page and GIFs, README, CREDITS and AI usage audit, commit history check.	Public itch.io build submitted by Hour 96.
96 - 100	Safety margin. Re-verify the live itch.io build and the repository.	Strict code freeze at Hour 100.

4. HOW THE WORK IS SPLIT

- **Claude Code:** architecture, vampire AI and the choice system, fights, level generator, narrator event scripting, bug fixing, code review and merges.
- **Antigravity:** hero and villain art, level themes, UI, shaders and transitions, audio, browser (Playwright) playtests, the itch.io page.
- **ChatGPT / Codex:** tests, balance data, documentation, README and CREDITS, small isolated features.
- **Developer (Sankeerth):** all design decisions, the story, hero and villain concepts, the Narrator's script, the playtests, every merge to `main`. Design choices are logged in `docs/DESIGN_LOG.md`.
- **Method:** each tool works in its own git worktree and owns separate folders, a shared task board (`docs/TASKS.md`) tracks everything, commits are small and frequent so the history is auditable.

5. QUALITY, COMPLIANCE AND RISKS

Area	Plan
Stability	Headless unit tests for the puzzle model, level validator for every puzzle, a generator test that builds 100+ levels and checks reachability, a Playwright browser run on every milestone build.
Assets	Only free, CC0, CC BY, open-source or AI-generated assets. Everything listed in <code>CREDITS.md</code> and on the itch.io page. No paid assets.
AI disclosure	Claude Code, Antigravity and ChatGPT/Codex are used for code, art, audio and documents. Every use is logged in <code>docs/AI_USAGE.md</code> . Core design and story direction are the developer's.
Code origin	All game code is written inside the 100 hours. Only a generic empty Godot project and an editor plugin used for tooling (not part of the game) were present at the start; the plugin is credited.
Risk: a pure-chance choice feels unfair	The gamble is by design, so all four outcomes must be fun, not punishing: a suspense scene before the result, a rewarding villain fight, a meaningful friend. Playtests check testers enjoy the moment, not just the result. Fallback: level 1 always has the friend first (tutorial).
Risk: par times are missed	Task counts and mini-game difficulty are tuned from timed playtests so the four levels take about 2, 3, 4 and 5 minutes. Players who run over par get an easier next level (already built), so the whole run stays near 17 to 19 minutes with the 3 minute boss.
Risk: vampire AI is hard to tune	Keep it simple (patrol, flee from light, freeze in the beam). Fallback: the villain sabotages on a fixed schedule.
Risk: scope (largest plan item)	The vampire, choice and ally system is built first (Hours 12 to 55) and everything else is cut around it, never the other way round.
Risk: combat is not fun	The parkour chase is a classic, readable platformer (run, jump, checkpoints) and the boss reuses torch light, mirrors and hearts. Playtests at Hour 45 (parkour) and Hour 70 (the duels). Fallbacks: shorter parkour with fewer hazards, the duels drop the mirror part.
Risk: art style workload	Genres are palette, font and caption swaps over one shared set of procedural shapes. Fallback: two genres instead of four.
Risk: web performance	2D lights are limited to the hero's torch; test every milestone in a browser; keep the export under 40 MB.
Risk: AI quota limits	Work is split across three tools with a handoff note on the task board; the developer reassigns tasks to whichever tool has quota left.

6. DEFINITION OF DONE

- A public itch.io page with a playable browser build of the full 17 to 19 minute game.
- The README shows the itch.io link, setup, controls and team details. CREDITS and the AI usage log are complete.
- The final game matches this plan: all committed features present, nothing from the cut list promised.